

Pune Paneer Safety & Supply-Chain Risk Analysis

Independent Business Analyst Portfolio Case Study | Research cut-off: 26 September 2026

Objective: organize public evidence of paneer-related enforcement activity in Pune, distinguish enforcement evidence from market-wide prevalence, identify traceability/control gaps, and propose a restaurant-level quality-control framework.

Executive summary

Pune has seen repeated reported enforcement activity involving paneer and other dairy products. The public evidence set used in this case study contains four Pune events from 2023 through September 2026. Across the four cited events, the reported/seized paneer quantity sums to 14,315 kg. This figure is a cumulative total of enforcement reports, not an estimate of the quantity of adulterated paneer sold in Pune and not a probability of adulteration.

The strongest quantitative benchmark available in public reporting is statewide rather than Pune-specific: Maharashtra surveillance between 1 April 2025 and 31 March 2026 analysed 308 paneer and dairy-analogue samples; 109 (35.4%) were reported non-conforming, including 79 sub-standard and 30 unsafe. This benchmark should not be presented as a Pune risk rate.

Research question and BA framing

Business question: How can a restaurant or food-service business reduce the risk of receiving non-compliant or misrepresented paneer when public market-level supplier and laboratory data are fragmented?

Key BA insight: the problem is not only product authenticity. It is traceability. Public enforcement reports often identify seized stock, locations and suspected issues, but they do not consistently connect supplier, batch, outlet, sample and final laboratory outcome in one public dataset.

What the public evidence shows

Date	Pune evidence	Quantity / scale	Status / caveat
11 May 2023	Chinchwad dairy unit raided	109 kg paneer	Samples sent for testing; final lab result not stated in cited article
8 Mar 2025	Manjri Khurd / Wagholi manufacturing unit raided	1,400 kg paneer	Enforcement report; public article does not provide a final lab report
7 Jun 2026	17-location Pune FDA raid	2,806 kg paneer; 35 mixed dairy samples	35 samples covered paneer, khoya, cheese analogue and ghee; testing pending in report
11 Sep 2026	Large supplier/distributor raid	Around 10,000 kg suspected paneer	Samples being collected; stock suspected by officials to originate from Karnataka

Interpretation: the sequence shows repeated enforcement attention and several large reported seizures. It does not prove a year-over-year market prevalence trend because enforcement intensity, number of locations, products covered and laboratory status differ between events.

Regulatory context

FSSAI's standard for Chhana and Paneer defines paneer as a product obtained from milk (with or without added milk solids) by precipitation with permitted acidulants and heating. The standard includes composition requirements, including milk-fat specifications. This provides a product-definition benchmark for the case study.

FSSAI also published a 2025 consultation paper proposing clearer disclosure where dairy analogues are used in HoReCa, including prefixing 'Non-dairy' or 'Analogue' before the relevant dairy term. This is a consultation proposal, not the same thing as an enacted universal rule.

Maharashtra FDA lists a one-year prohibition on analogue/non-dairy paneer, and reporting on the July 2026 order states that the measure followed statewide surveillance in which 109 of 308 analysed samples were non-conforming. The order applies across Maharashtra; this project uses it as current regulatory context, not as a Pune-specific market statistic.

Current national regulatory direction

FSSAI's notification archive shows a draft amendment dated 24 September 2026 relating to restrictions on paneer made of constituents not derived from milk. Because this is a draft notification, it should be described as an emerging policy direction rather than a final nationwide rule.

Data availability assessment

Outlet tier	Public risk rate	Supplier record	Public lab linkage	What would be needed
Street-food / hawker	Not publicly available	Not publicly available	No representative Pune lab dataset found	Primary sampling / survey needed
Mid-range restaurant	Not publicly available	Not publicly available	No public restaurant-tier lab linkage found	Primary sampling + supplier questionnaire needed
Premium / independent restaurant	Not publicly available	Not publicly available	No public restaurant-tier lab linkage found	Primary sampling + supplier questionnaire needed
3-star hotel	Not publicly available	Not publicly available	No public restaurant-tier lab linkage found	Primary sampling + procurement audit needed
5-star hotel	Not publicly available	Not publicly available	No public restaurant-tier lab linkage found	Primary sampling + procurement audit needed

This data gap is part of the business analysis. A defensible portfolio should not manufacture tier-specific risk percentages for street vendors, mid-range restaurants, premium restaurants, 3-star hotels or 5-star hotels when the public sources do not provide the required representative sample and lab linkage.

Supply-chain risk view

Based on the public cases, several control points are relevant to restaurant procurement. These are proposed analytical control points rather than a claim about every Pune restaurant's sourcing pattern.

Control point	Observed public clue	BA implication
Manufacturing	2023 and 2025 cases describe suspicious/illegal manufacturing and non-dairy inputs	Supplier qualification and source verification matter before purchase
Documentation	June 2026 report mentions stock without labels or purchase invoices	No document = lower traceability and harder root-cause investigation
Storage / hygiene	June 2026 report mentions unhygienic storage	Receiving and storage checks should be recorded, not assumed
Distribution	Sep 2026 report describes a large supplier/distribution case with suspected interstate origin	Batch and supplier traceability should follow the product through the chain
Testing	Pune reports say samples were sent/being collected	Test result capture is necessary to close the loop from seizure to confirmed outcome

Restaurant quality-control framework

1. Supplier onboarding: verify business identity and FSSAI licence/registration status before approval. FSSAI provides a public licence verification facility and a Food Safety Connect mechanism for complaints and verification.
2. Purchase traceability: retain supplier, invoice, batch, date, quantity and product declaration for every paneer receipt.
3. Receiving checks: inspect packaging/labels, batch details, condition and storage/transport indicators; record exceptions.
4. Risk-based testing: increase testing frequency when supplier history, documentation or exception patterns indicate higher risk. Use appropriate/notified laboratories according to the business's compliance program.
5. Supplier scorecard: track documentation compliance, test outcomes, complaint rate, corrective-action responsiveness and repeat exceptions.
6. Exception dashboard: monitor quality KPIs and trigger management review when predefined thresholds are breached.
7. Consumer transparency: where non-dairy analogues are legally permitted, accurate disclosure should be aligned with applicable rules. Do not advertise '100% pure' unless the business has an evidence-based basis for the claim.

Future-state operating model

Current state: supplier selected -> product received -> used in kitchen -> complaint/inspection -> investigation.

Future state: supplier qualification -> licence/document verification -> approved supplier -> batch-level receiving log -> risk-based testing -> supplier scorecard -> dashboard exception -> corrective action -> audit trail.

What to measure

KPI	Purpose
Supplier documentation compliance %	Measure traceability discipline
Paneer test pass rate	Measure quality outcome where testing exists
Repeat exception rate	Identify recurring supplier / receiving issues
Invoice-to-batch traceability %	Measure ability to trace stock upstream
Complaint rate per 1,000 kg	Normalize customer issue volume against usage
Corrective action closure time	Measure responsiveness

Conclusion

The project does not conclude that a particular restaurant tier is safe or unsafe. The available evidence is too incomplete for that comparison. Instead, the analysis identifies a repeat pattern of enforcement activity, highlights a statewide testing benchmark, surfaces data limitations, and translates those findings into a practical quality-control model that a restaurant business could implement.

Research sources

SRC_01 | 2026-09-24 | FSSAI | Draft Food Safety and Standards (Prohibition and Restrictions on Sales) Amendment Regulations, 2026 relating to restriction of paneer made of constituents not derived from milk
<https://fssai.gov.in/food-law/notifications>

SRC_02 | 2017-10-24 | FSSAI | Gazette Notification - Standard for Chhana and Paneer
https://www.fssai.gov.in/upload/uploadfiles/files/Gazette_Notification_Milk_Products_24_10_2017.pdf

SRC_03 | 2023-05-11 | The Indian Express | Dairy unit making adulterated paneer busted in Chinchwad
<https://indianexpress.com/article/cities/pune/dairy-unit-adulterated-paneer-chinchwad-goods-worth-8603405/>

SRC_04 | 2025-03-08 | Hindustan Times | Pune police seize 1,400 kg contaminated paneer worth Rs 11 lakh
<https://www.hindustantimes.com/cities/pune-news/pune-police-seize-1-400-kg-contaminated-paneer-worth-11-lakh-101741374185066.html>

SRC_05 | 2026-06-07 | Times of India | Suspicious khoya, paneer and ghee worth Rs 47 lakh seized in Pune
<https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/pune/suspicious-khoya-paneer-and-ghee-worth-47-lakh-seized-in-pune/articleshow/131558578.cms>

SRC_06 | 2026-09-11 | India Today | 10,000 kg adulterated paneer, 5,000 kg fake khoya seized in massive Pune crackdown
<https://www.indiatoday.in/cities/pune/story/pune-fda-raid-seizes-suspected-fake-paneer-and-khoya-amid-maharashtra-ban-2992231-2026-09-11>

SRC_07 | 2026-07-30 | Maharashtra FDA | Prohibition of Analogue / Non-Dairy Paneer
<https://fda.maharashtra.gov.in/related-acts-circulars/>

SRC_08 | 2026-09-23 | FSSAI | Food Safety Connect
<https://www.fssai.gov.in/food-safety-connect>

SRC_09 | 2026-04-01 to 2026-03-31 | Maharashtra FDA / reported in Indian Express and Hindustan Times | Statewide surveillance result: 109 of 308 analysed paneer/dairy-analogue samples non-conforming
<https://indianexpress.com/article/cities/mumbai/no-more-non-dairy-analog-paneer-on-your-plate-as-maharashtra-enforces-ban-for-a-year-failed-fda-test-10818916/lite/>

SRC_10 | 2025-03-11 | FSSAI | Ensuring Safe Festivities: FSSAI Directs States to Step Up Food Safety Checks on Dairy Analogues
https://www.fssai.gov.in/upload/uploadfiles/files/pressRelease_surveillance_drive.pdf

SRC_11 | 2025-04 | FSSAI | Consultation Paper - Provisions of 'Analogue in Dairy Context'
<https://www.fssai.gov.in/upload/advisories/2025/04/67ffa639c8c29Consultation%20Paper%20for%20inviting%20comments.pdf>